

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12415468
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
Inventor(s)	Saito; Ryuta et al.

Wire harness

Abstract

A wire harness including; a wire harness main body including an electric wire and an outer cover covering an outer circumference of the electric wire; a first route regulator that is attached to an outer circumference of the outer cover and regulates a route of the wire harness main body; and an attachment that is attached to a portion of an outer circumference of the first route regulator in a lengthwise direction of the first route regulator.

Inventors: Saito; Ryuta (Yokkaichi, JP), Izawa; Katsutoshi (Yokkaichi, JP), Tanaka; Kosuke (Yokkaichi, JP)

Applicant: SUMITOMO WIRING SYSTEMS, LTD. (Yokkaichi, JP)

Family ID: 1000008820101

Assignee: SUMITOMO WIRING SYSTEMS, LTD. (Mie, JP)

Appl. No.: 17/990136

Filed: November 18, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230166674 A1	Jun. 01, 2023

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2021-192255	Nov. 26, 2021
----	-------------	---------------

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: B60R16/02 (20060101); H01B7/40 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H02G (3/04); H02G (3/30); H02G (3/32); H02G (3/40); H02G (3/0418); H02G (3/0462); H02G (3/0481); B60R (16/0207); B60R (16/0215); H01B (7/0045)

References Cited**U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS**

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
2408253	12/1945	Diebold	174/136	H02G 7/00
3810490	12/1973	Ludwick	138/110	F16L 3/00
4563542	12/1985	Pollack	174/68.3	H02G 3/266
5160105	12/1991	Miller	248/188.9	A47C 7/002
5560397	12/1995	Miller	138/110	H02G 3/22
5664520	12/1996	Latimer, III	16/431	E05C 17/04
7740211	12/2009	Dukes	248/74.1	H02G 1/08
8505858	12/2012	Hansen	174/664	F16L 3/1226
9062801	12/2014	Billarant	N/A	F16L 3/1236
10139015	12/2017	VanValkenburgh	N/A	F16L 3/02
10903632	12/2020	Toll	N/A	F16L 3/1058
11378214	12/2021	Wolf	N/A	F16L 3/1222
2008/0116324	12/2007	Holder	248/65	F16L 3/1226
2014/0027584	12/2013	Pauchet	248/68.1	F16L 3/123
2014/0069691	12/2013	Cox	174/135	F02C 7/00
2014/0131528	12/2013	Blakeley	248/74.2	H02G 3/32
2016/0336682	12/2015	Markefka	N/A	H02G 3/0691
2017/0085067	12/2016	Sugimoto	N/A	H01R 13/5812
2018/0375306	12/2017	Peterson	N/A	H02G 3/0456
2019/0089142	12/2018	Sugino	N/A	N/A
2020/0274343	12/2019	Sugino	N/A	N/A

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
2019-053894	12/2018	JP	N/A

Primary Examiner: Paghadal; Paresh

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Oliff PLC

Background/Summary**BACKGROUND**

(1) The present disclosure relates to a wire harness.

(2) Conventionally, an example of a wire harness for a vehicle is a wire harness that includes: a wire harness main body that includes an electric wire member and an outer cover member that covers the electric wire member; and a route-regulating member that is attached to an outer

circumference thereof of an outer cover member and regulates the route of the wire harness main body (for example, see JP 2019-53894A).

SUMMARY

(3) Incidentally, in the above-mentioned wire harness, a route-regulating member may be attached to an attachment member such as another route-regulating member, and in such a case, it is desired that no rattling occurs at an attachment site between the route-regulating member and an attachment member. Note that rattling at the attachment site leads to damage at the attachment site caused by vibration or the like, for example.

(4) An exemplary aspect of the disclosure provides a wire harness capable of suppressing rattling.

(5) The wire harness of the present disclosure includes: a wire harness main body including an electric wire and an outer cover covering an outer circumference of the electric wire; a first route regulator that is attached to an outer circumference of the outer cover and regulates a route of the wire harness main body; and an attachment that is attached to a portion of an outer circumference of the first route regulator in a lengthwise direction of the first route regulator, wherein: the first route regulator includes an insertion port that is open in a direction orthogonal to the lengthwise direction of the first route regulator and extends along an entire first route regulator in the lengthwise direction of the first route regulator, and the attachment includes a receiver covering a portion in a circumferential direction of the first route regulator, and a pliable band that covers an entire circumference of the first route regulator together with the receiver and binds the receiver and the first route regulator together.

(6) According to a wire harness of this disclosure, it is possible to suppress rattling.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic configuration diagram showing a wire harness according to an embodiment.

(2) FIG. 2 is a schematic perspective view showing a wire harness according to an embodiment.

(3) FIG. 3 is a schematic perspective view showing a wire harness according to an embodiment.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic exploded perspective view showing a wire harness according to an embodiment.

(5) FIG. 5 is a schematic side view showing a wire harness according to an embodiment.

(6) FIG. 6 is a schematic transverse cross-sectional view showing a wire harness according to an embodiment.

(7) FIG. 7 is a schematic side view showing a wire harness according to a modified example.

(8) FIG. 8 is a schematic transverse cross-sectional view showing a wire harness according to a modified example.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

Description of Embodiments of Present Disclosure

(9) First, aspects of the present disclosure will be listed and described.

(10) The wire harness of the present disclosure includes:

(11) [1] a wire harness main body including an electric wire member and an outer cover member covering an outer circumference of the electric wire member; a first route-regulating member that is attached to an outer circumference of the outer cover member and regulates a route of the wire harness main body; and an attachment member that is attached to a portion of an outer circumference of the first route-regulating member in a lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member, in which the first route-regulating member includes an insertion port that is open in a direction orthogonal to the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member and extends along the entire first route-regulating member in the lengthwise direction of the first route-

regulating member, and the attachment member includes a receiving portion covering a portion in a circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member, and a pliable band that covers the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member together with the receiving portion and binds the receiving portion and the first route-regulating member together.

(12) According to this configuration, the receiving portion and the first route-regulating member are bound together using the pliable band covering the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member together with the receiving portion covering a portion in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member. Doing so suppresses rattling between the receiving portion and the first route-regulating member compared to a configuration in which a lid is integrated with the receiving portion via thin hinge portions and the lid is locked to the receiving portion through engagement using a claw portion in a closed state, for example. That is, in a configuration in which thin hinge portions and claw portions are provided, rattling between the receiving portion and the lid occurs at the hinge portions and the claw portions, but such rattling can be avoided. Therefore, the receiving portion and the band can hold the first route-regulating member without rattling, and thus rattling between the first route-regulating member and the attachment member can be suppressed.

(13) [2] It is preferable that the band is a cable tie that includes a pliable belt-shaped portion and a locking portion that is provided at an end portion of the belt-shaped portion in a lengthwise direction of the belt-shaped portion and regulates movement of the belt-shaped portion in a removing direction, which is a direction opposite to a direction in which the belt-shaped portion is passed therethrough, in a state in which the belt-shaped portion is passed therethrough, and the cable tie is attached so as to cover the entire circumferential portion of the receiving portion and cover the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member together with the receiving portion.

(14) According to this configuration, because the band is a cable tie that includes the belt-shaped portion and the locking portion, a known cable tie can be used, for example, and be easily obtained. Also, because the cable tie is attached so as to cover the entire circumferential portion of the receiving portion and cover the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member together with the receiving portion, it is possible to bind the receiving portion and the first route-regulating member together so as to fasten the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member, and to favorably suppress rattling between the receiving portion and the first route-regulating member.

(15) [3] It is preferable that the receiving portion includes an engagement portion capable of engaging with the belt-shaped portion in a lengthwise direction of the receiving portion.

(16) According to this configuration, because the receiving portion includes the engagement portion capable of engaging with the belt-shaped portion in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion, it is possible to inhibit the belt-shaped portion from shifting in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion. Therefore, rattling between the receiving portion and the first route-regulating member can be stably suppressed.

(17) [4] It is preferable that the engagement portion is provided at two end portions of the receiving portion in a circumferential direction of the receiving portion.

(18) According to this configuration, because the engagement portion is provided at two end portions of the receiving portion in the circumferential direction thereof, it is possible to favorably inhibit the belt-shaped portion from shifting in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion.

(19) [5] It is preferable that the band extends from one end portion of the receiving portion in the circumferential direction of the receiving portion, is fixed to the other end portion, and binds the receiving portion and the first route-regulating member together.

(20) [6] It is preferable that the band is a component molded integrally with the receiving portion.

(21) According to this configuration, because the band is a component molded integrally with the receiving portion, the number of components can be reduced compared to a configuration in which the band and the receiving portion are separate from each other, for example.

(22) [7] It is preferable that the attachment member is a second route-regulating member that is attached to the outer circumference of the outer cover member and regulates the route of the wire harness main body, and the receiving portion is provided at an end portion in a lengthwise direction of the second route-regulating member and covers a circumferential portion of an end portion in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member.

(23) According to this configuration, because the receiving portion is provided at the end portion in the lengthwise direction of the second route-regulating member and covers the circumferential portion of the end portion in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member, the first route-regulating member and the second route-regulating member are connected to each other in the lengthwise direction. Therefore, the route of the wire harness main body is regulated by the first route-regulating member and the second route-regulating member.

(24) [8] It is preferable that the first route-regulating member regulates the route of a straight section, which is a section having a linear shape in the route of the wire harness main body, and the second route-regulating member regulates the route of a bent section, which is a section that is bent in the route of the wire harness main body.

(25) According to this configuration, the route of the straight section is regulated by the first route-regulating member, and the route of the bent section is regulated by the second route-regulating member. As a result, the routes of the straight section and the bent section of the wire harness are continuously prevented from deviating from the desired routes.

Details of Embodiments of the Present Disclosure

(26) Specific examples of the wire harness of the present disclosure will be described below with reference to the drawings. In each drawing, for convenience of description, portions of the configuration may be exaggerated or simplified. Also, the dimensional proportions of each portion may differ between drawings. In the present specification, “parallel” and “orthogonal” include not only the case of being strictly parallel and orthogonal, but also the case of being approximately parallel and orthogonal within a range in which the actions and effects of the present embodiment are exhibited. Note that the present disclosure is not limited to these examples, and is indicated by the claims, and is intended to include all modifications within the meaning and scope equivalent to the claims.

(27) Overall Configuration of Wire Harness **10**

(28) A wire harness **10** shown in FIG. **1** is to be mounted in a vehicle V such as a hybrid vehicle or an electric vehicle, for example. The wire harness **10** electrically connects two or more on-board devices to each other. The on-board devices are electric devices mounted in the vehicle V. The wire harness **10** electrically connects, for example, an inverter M1 that is installed in a front portion of the vehicle V and a high-voltage battery M2 that is installed rearward of the inverter M1 in the vehicle V, to each other. The wire harness **10** has an elongated shape that extends in a front-rear direction of the vehicle V, for example. The wire harness **10** is routed in the vehicle V so that, for example, an intermediate portion in the lengthwise direction of the wire harness **10** passes outside the vehicle interior such as under the floor of the vehicle V.

(29) The inverter M1 is, for example, connected to a motor (not shown) for driving wheels, which serves as a power source when the vehicle travels. The inverter M1 generates AC power from the DC power of the high-voltage battery M2, and supplies the AC power to the motor. The high-voltage battery M2 is, for example, a battery that is capable of supplying a voltage of several hundred volts.

(30) The wire harness **10** includes a wire harness main body **11**. The wire harness main body **11** includes an electric wire member **20** (electric wire) and a tubular outer cover member **30** (outer cover) that covers the outer circumference of the electric wire member **20**. The wire harness **10** has connectors C1 and C2 that are respectively attached to two end portions of the electric wire member **20**. One end portion in the lengthwise direction of the electric wire member **20** is connected to the inverter M1 via the connector C1, and the other end portion in the lengthwise

direction of the electric wire member **20** is connected to the high-voltage battery M2 via the connector C2.

(31) As shown in FIGS. **2** and **3**, the wire harness **10** includes a first route-regulating member **40** (first route regulator) that is attached to the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** and a second route-regulating member **60** (second route regulator) that is attached to the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** and serves as an attachment member. The first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** regulate the route along which the wire harness main body **11** is routed. Note that the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** are omitted from FIG. **1**.

(32) Configuration of Electric Wire Member **20**

(33) As shown in FIGS. **4** and **6**, for example, the electric wire member **20** includes one or more electric wires **21** (e.g., two electric wires **21** in this embodiment) and a braided member **25** that collectively encloses the outer circumferences of the plurality of electric wires **21**.

(34) As shown in FIG. **6**, each electric wire **21** is a coated electric wire that includes a conductive core wire **22** and an insulating coating **23** that encloses the outer circumference of the core wire **22** and has insulating properties. Each electric wire **21** is, for example, a high-voltage electric wire that can support a high voltage and a large current. Each electric wire **21** may be, for example, a non-shielded electric wire that does not include an electromagnetic shield structure, or a shielded electric wire that includes an electromagnetic shield structure. Each electric wire **21** in the present embodiment is a non-shielded electric wire.

(35) As the core wire **22**, a stranded wire that is constituted by a plurality of metal strands twisted together, a single core wire that is constituted by a single conductor, or the like may be used, for example. As the single core wire, a columnar conductor that is constituted by one columnar metal rod with a solid internal structure, a tubular conductor with a hollow internal structure, or the like may be used, for example. As the core wire **22**, a combination of a stranded wire, a columnar conductor, or a tubular conductor may be used. As the material of the core wire **22**, a metal material such as a copper-based material or an aluminium-based material may be used, for example.

(36) The insulating coating **23** covers, for example, all the way around the outer circumferential surface of the core wire **22**. The insulating coating **23** is constituted by, for example, a resin material that has insulating properties.

(37) The cross-sectional shape of each wire **21** taken along a plane that is orthogonal to the lengthwise direction of each wire **21**, that is, the transverse cross-sectional shape of each wire **21**, may be any shape. The transverse cross-sectional shape of each electric wire **21** may be, for example, a circular shape, a semi-circular shape, a polygonal shape, a square shape, a flat shape, or the like. The transverse cross-sectional shape of each electric wire **21** in the present embodiment is a circular shape.

(38) The braided member **25** has, for example, an overall tubular shape that collectively encloses the outer circumferences of the plurality of electric wires **21**. As the braided member **25**, a braided wire in which a plurality of metal strands are braided or a braided wire in which metal strands and resin strands are braided in combination with each other may be used, for example. As the material of the metal strands, a metal material such as a copper-based material or an aluminium-based material may be used, for example. Although not shown in the drawings, the two end portions of the braided member **25** in the lengthwise direction are grounded at, for example, the connectors C1 and C2 (see FIG. **1**).

(39) Configuration of Outer Cover Member **30**

(40) As shown in FIG. **4**, the outer cover member **30** has a tubular shape that encloses all the way around the outer circumference of the electric wire member **20**. The outer cover member **30** in the present embodiment is formed in a cylindrical shape. The outer cover member **30** is, for example, provided with a circumferential wall that is formed so as to be continuous all the way around the circumferential surface of the outer cover member **30**. The outer cover member **30** seals, for

example, the inside of the outer cover member **30** all the way around the circumferential surface of the outer cover member **30**. The outer cover member **30** has, for example, a function of protecting the electric wire member **20** from flying objects and water droplets.

(41) The outer cover member **30** is, for example, flexible and is easy to bend. Examples of the flexible outer cover member **30** include a resin corrugated tube and a rubber waterproof cover. The outer cover member **30** of this embodiment is a resin corrugated tube having an accordion shape whose diameter repeatedly increases and decreases in the lengthwise direction of the outer cover member **30**. That is, the outer cover member **30** of this embodiment has an accordion structure in which large-diameter portions **31** and small-diameter portions **32** whose diameter is smaller than that of the large-diameter portions **31** are alternately and continuously provided along the lengthwise direction of the outer cover member **30**. Each of the large-diameter portions **31** and the small-diameter portions **32** has, for example, a ring shape that encircles the outer cover member **30** once in the circumferential direction. As the material of the outer cover member **30**, for example, a synthetic resin such as polyolefin, polyamide, polyester, or ABS resin can be used. Note that in FIGS. **1** to **3**, the outer cover member **30** is shown simplified for the sake of simplifying the drawings.

(42) Configuration of First Route-Regulating Member **40** and Second Route-Regulating Member **60**

(43) As shown in FIGS. **2** and **3**, each of the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** holds the outer cover member **30**. Each of the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** is harder than, for example, the outer cover member **30**. Each of the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** has a hardness that makes it less likely to bend in a direction orthogonal to the lengthwise direction of the wire harness main body **11** compared to the outer cover member **30**. As a result, the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** regulate the route of the wire harness main body **11**. For example, the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** assist the outer cover member **30** so that the wire harness main body **11** does not deviate from the desired route as a result of bending under its own weight or the like.

(44) As shown in FIG. **2**, the first route-regulating member **40** is provided along a portion in the lengthwise direction of the wire harness main body **11**. For example, the first route-regulating member **40** is attached to the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** along a straight section **11A**, which is a straight section of the route of the wire harness main body **11**. The first route-regulating member **40** regulates the route of the wire harness main body **11** in the straight section **11A**. Here, the straight section **11A** is a section in which the route of the wire harness main body **11** extends linearly in one direction. Note that one or more first route-regulating members **40** are provided depending on the route of the wire harness main body **11**.

(45) The second route-regulating member **60** is provided along a portion in the lengthwise direction of the wire harness main body **11**. For example, the second route-regulating member **60** is attached to the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** along a bent section **11B**, which is a bent section of the route of the wire harness main body **11**. The second route-regulating member **60** regulates the route of the wire harness main body **11** in the bent section **11B**. Here, the bent section **11B** is a section in which the route of the wire harness main body **11** is bent so as to deviate from a straight line. Note that one or more second route-regulating members **60** are provided depending on the route of the wire harness main body **11**.

(46) Configuration of First Route-Regulating Member **40**

(47) As shown in FIG. **6**, the first route-regulating member **40** covers a portion of the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** in the circumferential direction of the outer cover member **30**. The first route-regulating member **40** has a shape that covers a portion of the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** in the circumferential direction of the outer cover member **30**. The transverse cross-sectional shape of the first route-regulating member **40** is C-

shaped overall. The first route-regulating member **40** covers, for example, an area greater than half of the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30**. That is, the first route-regulating member **40** covers an area greater than half of the entire outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** in the circumferential direction of the outer cover member **30**. As shown in FIG. 2, the first route-regulating member **40** extends in the lengthwise direction of the outer cover member **30** in the straight section **11A**. The first route-regulating member **40** is formed in a shape extending linearly in one direction, for example. The transverse cross-sectional shape of the first route-regulating member **40** is, for example, uniform over the entire length of the first route-regulating member **40** in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**.

(48) The first route-regulating member **40** is made of metal or resin, for example. The first route-regulating member **40** in the present embodiment is made of resin. As the material of the first route-regulating member **40**, a synthetic resin such as polypropylene, polyamide, or polyacetal may be used, for example. The first route-regulating member **40** may be manufactured using a well-known manufacturing method such as extrusion molding or injection molding, for example. In this embodiment, the first route-regulating member **40** is an extruded product manufactured through extrusion molding. Therefore, the first route-regulating member **40** can be easily manufactured using an extrusion machine that extrudes a raw material of the first route-regulating member **40** in a lengthwise direction. Also, a plurality types of first route-regulating members **40** having different dimensions in the lengthwise direction can be manufactured using a single extrusion machine. A plurality types of first route-regulating members **40** having different dimensions in the lengthwise direction can be manufactured by cutting a base material of the first route-regulating member **40**, which has been formed using a single extrusion machine, using a cutting device to a desired length, for example.

(49) The first route-regulating member **40** has an insertion port **40X** that is open in a direction orthogonal to the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The insertion port **40X** extends along the entire first route-regulating member **40** in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The first route-regulating member **40** has a first end portion **41** and a second end portion **42** that are two end portions in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40** and form the insertion port **40X**. The first route-regulating member **40** has a connection portion **43** that connects the first end portion **41** and the second end portion **42** to each other. In other words, the first route-regulating member **40** has the connection portion **43** formed so as to cover a portion of the outer cover member **30** in the circumferential direction thereof, the first end portion **41** and the second end portion **42** that are provided at two end portions of the connection portion **43**, and the insertion port **40X** formed by the first end portion **41** and the second end portion **42**.

(50) As shown in FIG. 6, the connection portion **43** forms the main part of the first route-regulating member **40**. The thickness in the radial direction of connection portion **43** is, for example, uniform in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The transverse cross-sectional shape of the connection portion **43** is formed, for example, in a shape that extends along the outer surface of the outer cover member **30**. The transverse cross-sectional shapes of the first end portion **41**, the second end portion **42**, and the connection portion **43** are formed, for example, in an arc shape.

(51) The first end portion **41** and the second end portion **42** are provided on mutually opposite sides in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The first end portion **41** and the second end portion **42** are provided spaced apart from each other with the insertion port **40X** interposed therebetween in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. In other words, the gap between the first end portion **41** and the second end portion **42** in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40** forms the insertion port **40X**. As described above, the first route-regulating member **40** is formed in a C shape having the insertion port **40X** in a portion in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40**.

(52) The transverse cross-sectional shapes of the leading ends of the first end portion **41** and the second end portion **42** are formed in curved shapes. The transverse cross-sectional shapes of the leading ends of the first end portion **41** and the second end portion **42** in this embodiment are formed in arc shapes.

(53) The first route-regulating portion **40** has a protruding portion **45** that protrudes from the inner surface of the first end portion **41** and a protruding portion **46** that protrudes from the inner surface of the second end portion **42**. The protruding portions **45** and **46** protrude toward the outer cover member **30** inserted into the first route-regulating member **40** and come into contact with the outer surface of the outer cover member **30**. The protruding portions **45** and **46** are in contact with the outer surfaces of large-diameter portions **31** of the outer cover member **30**. The protruding portion **45** protrudes from the inner surface of the leading end of the first end portion **41**, for example. The protruding portion **46** protrudes from the inner surface of the leading end of the second end portion **42**, for example. The transverse cross-sectional shapes of the protruding portions **45** and **46** are formed in curved shapes, for example. The transverse cross-sectional shapes of the protruding portions **45** and **46** in this embodiment are formed in arc shapes.

(54) As shown in FIG. 3, the protruding portions **45** and **46** extend in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The protruding portions **45** and **46** extend along the entire length of the first route-regulating member **40** in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**, for example.

(55) The protruding portions **45** and **46** press the outer cover member **30** from the outer side of the outer cover member **30**. The outer cover member **30** is elastically held by the protruding portions **45** and **46**, and the connection portion **43**. As a result, the connection between the first route-regulating member **40** and the outer cover member **30** is strengthened.

(56) As shown in FIG. 6, the opening width of the insertion port **40X**, that is, the shortest distance between the first end portion **41** and the second end portion **42**, is smaller than the outer diameter of the outer cover member **30**.

(57) When the first route-regulating member **40** is elastically deformed, the opening width of the insertion port **40X** increases. When the outer cover member **30** is inserted into the insertion port **40X** in a direction orthogonal to the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**, for example, the opening width of the insertion port **40X** increases. Once the outer cover member **30** has been inserted into the first route-regulating member **40**, the first route-regulating member **40** elastically returns to return to its original shape. As a result, the opening width of the insertion port **40X** becomes smaller than the outer diameter of the outer cover member **30**, and therefore the first route-regulating member **40** is attached to the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30**.

(58) Configuration of Second Route-Regulating Member **60**

(59) As shown in FIG. 2, the second route-regulating member **60** is attached to a portion of the outer circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** in the lengthwise direction. The second route-regulating member **60** is attached to the outer circumference of an end portion in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. Also, the second route-regulating member **60** is attached to the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** in the bent section **11B**. The second route-regulating member **60** extends in the lengthwise direction of the outer cover member **30** in the bent section **11B**. The second route-regulating member **60** is bent following the shape of the bent section **11B**, for example.

(60) The second route-regulating member **60** has a second route-regulating main body **61** and a cable tie **62** serving as a band.

(61) The second route-regulating main body **61** and the cable tie **62** that constitute the second route-regulating member **60** are made of metal or resin, for example. The second route-regulating main body **61** and the cable tie **62** in this embodiment are made of resin. As the materials of the second route-regulating main body **61** and the cable tie **62**, for example, a synthetic resin such as polypropylene, polyamide, or polyacetal can be used. The second route-regulating main body **61**

and the cable tie **62** may be manufactured using a well-known manufacturing method such as injection molding, for example.

(62) The second route-regulating main body **61** includes a main body portion **64** and a receiving portion **65** (receiver).

(63) The main body portion **64** covers a portion of the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** in the circumferential direction of the outer cover member **30**. The main body portion **64** has a shape that covers a portion of the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** in the circumferential direction of the outer cover member **30**. The transverse cross-sectional shape of the main body portion **64** is semi-cylindrical overall. The main body portion **64** covers half of the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30**. As shown in FIG. 2, the main body portion **64** extends in the lengthwise direction of the outer cover member **30** in the bent section **11B**. The main body portion **64** is bent following the shape of the bent section **11B**.

(64) The receiving portion **65** is provided at an end portion in the lengthwise direction of the second route-regulating member **60**, i.e., an end surface in the lengthwise direction of the main body portion **64**. The receiving portion **65** covers a portion of the outer circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The receiving portion **65** covers a circumferential portion of the end portion in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The receiving portion **65** has a shape that covers a portion of the outer circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The transverse cross-sectional shape of the receiving portion **65** is semi-cylindrical overall. The receiving portion **65** has a semi-cylindrical shape whose diameter is larger than that of the main body portion **64**. The receiving portion **65** covers half of the outer circumference of the first route-regulating member **40**.

(65) As shown in FIGS. 2 to 6, the receiving portion **65** has engagement portions **66** (engagements). The engagement portions **66** are respectively provided at two end portions of the receiving portion **65** in the circumferential direction thereof. The engagement portions **66** protrude outward in a radial direction from the two end portions of the receiving portion **65** in the circumferential direction. As shown in FIG. 5, two engagement portions **66** are provided in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**. As shown in FIG. 6, each engagement portion **66** has a through-hole **67**. The through-hole **67** extends in a tangential direction of an arc extending along the outer circumferential surface of the receiving portion **65**. The directions in which the through-holes **67** of the two engagement portions **66** in the circumferential direction of the receiving portion **65** extend are parallel to each other.

(66) The cable tie **62** covers the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** together with the receiving portion **65** and binds the receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** together.

(67) Specifically, the cable tie **62** includes a flexible and pliable belt-shaped portion **68** (pliable belt) and a locking portion **69** (lock) provided at an end portion of the belt-shaped portion **68** in the lengthwise direction thereof. The locking portion **69** regulates movement of the belt-shaped portion **68** in a removing direction that is a direction opposite to the direction in which the belt-shaped portion **68** is passed therethrough, and locks the belt-shaped portion **68**, in a state in which the belt-shaped portion **68** is passed therethrough.

(68) The cable tie **62** is attached so as to cover the entire circumferential portion of the receiving portion **65** and cover the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** together with the receiving portion **65**, with the belt-shaped portion **68** being passed through the through-hole **67** of the engagement portion **66**. In other words, the cable tie **62** covers the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** along the outer circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** together with the receiving portion **65**. Also, the cable tie **62** binds the receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** together such that the first route-regulating member **40** does not separate from the receiving portion **65**. Further, the engagement portion **66** is capable of

engaging with the belt-shaped portion **68** in the lengthwise direction of the second route-regulating member **60** and in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**. The engagement portion **66** inhibits the belt-shaped portion **68** from shifting in the lengthwise direction of the second route-regulating member **60** and in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**. Note that once the leading end portion of the belt-shaped portion **68** that has been passed through the locking portion **69**, the leading portion is no longer required. Therefore, in FIGS. **2**, **5**, and **6** that show a state in which the cable tie **62** is attached, the leading end portion of the belt-shaped portion **68** is cut off.

(69) Also, as shown in FIG. **2**, the wire harness **10** includes a slide regulating member **70** that regulates sliding movement of the first route-regulating member **40** in the lengthwise direction of the outer cover member **30**, for example. The wire harness **10** includes a slide regulating member **71** that regulates sliding movement of the second route-regulating member **60** in the lengthwise direction of the outer cover member **30**, for example. Cable ties made of resin or metal, crimp rings, adhesive tape, or the like can be used as the slide regulating members **70** and **71**, for example. The slide regulating members **70** and **71** of this embodiment are pieces of adhesive tape. The slide regulating member **70** is wound around the end portion of the first route-regulating member **40** that is not connected to the second route-regulating member **60**, and the outer cover member **30**. The slide regulating member **71** is wound around the end portion of the second route-regulating member **60** that is not connected to the first route-regulating member **40**, and the outer cover member **30**.

(70) Next, operation of this embodiment will be described.

(71) The receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** are bound together using the cable tie **62**. Therefore, the state in which the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** are connected to each other is maintained. Thus, the route of the wire harness main body **11** is continuously regulated.

(72) Next, effects of the above-described embodiment will be described below.

(73) (1) The receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** are bound together using the pliable cable tie **62** that covers the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** together with the receiving portion **65** covering a portion of the first route-regulating member **40** in the circumferential direction. Doing so suppresses rattling between the receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** compared to a configuration in which a lid is integrated with the receiving portion **65** via thin hinge portions and the lid is locked to the receiving portion **65** through engagement using a claw portion in a closed state, for example. That is, in a configuration in which thin hinge portions and claw portions are provided, rattling between the receiving portion **65** and the lid is likely to occur at the hinge portions and the claw portions, but such rattling can be avoided. Therefore, the receiving portion **65** and the cable tie **62** can hold the first route-regulating member **40** without rattling, and it is possible to suppress rattling of the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60**. As a result, it is possible to suppress damage at the attachment site where the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** are attached to each other, and thus to stably regulate the route of the wire harness main body **11**.

(74) (2) Because the band that binds the receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** together is the cable tie **62** that includes the belt-shaped portion **68** and the locking portion **69**, a known cable tie can be used, for example, and be easily obtained. Also, because the cable tie **62** is attached so as to cover the entire circumferential portion of the receiving portion **65** and cover the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** together with the receiving portion **65**, it is possible to bind the receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** together so as to fasten the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member **40**. Therefore, rattling between the receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** can be favorably suppressed.

(75) (3) Because the receiving portion **65** has the engagement portions **66** that are each capable of engaging with the belt-shaped portion **68** in the lengthwise direction of the second route-regulating member **60** and in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**, it is possible to inhibit the belt-shaped portion **68** from shifting in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**. Therefore, rattling between the receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** can be stably suppressed.

(76) (4) Because the engagement portions **66** are respectively provided at two end portions of the receiving portion **65** in the circumferential direction thereof, it is possible to favorably inhibit the belt-shaped portions **68** from shifting in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**.

(77) (5) The attachment member (attachment) to be attached to the first route-regulating member **40** is the second route-regulating member **60** that is attached to the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30** and regulates the route of the wire harness main body **11**. Also, because the receiving portion **65** is provided at the end portion in the lengthwise direction of the second route-regulating member **60** and covers the circumferential portion of the end portion in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**, the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** are connected to each other in the lengthwise direction. Therefore, the route of the wire harness main body **11** is continuously regulated by the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60**.

(78) (6) The route of the straight section **11A** of the wire harness main body **11** is regulated by the first route-regulating member **40**, and the route of the bent section **11B** of the wire harness main body **11** is regulated by the second route-regulating member **60**. As a result, the routes of the straight section **11A** and the bent section **11B** of the wire harness main body **11** are continuously prevented from deviating from the desired routes.

OTHER EMBODIMENTS

(79) The above embodiment can be modified and implemented as follows. The above embodiment and the following modifications can be implemented in combination with each other as long as no contradiction arises. Although the engagement portions **66** each have the through-hole **67** in the above-described embodiment, the engagement portion **66** need not have the through-hole **67** as long as the engagement portion **66** is capable of engaging with the belt-shaped portion **68** in the lengthwise direction of the second route-regulating member **60** and in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**.

(80) Modifications can be made as shown in FIG. 7, for example. A pair of engagement portions **80** in this example are provided so as to protrude from the outer circumferential surface of the receiving portion **65** and be arranged side-by-side in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**. Note that two pairs of engagement portions **80** in this example are provided such that two engagement portions **80** are arranged side-by-side in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**. Also, the belt-shaped portion **68** is disposed to extend between the pair of engagement portions **80**. Doing this also can inhibit the belt-shaped portion **68** from shifting in the lengthwise direction of the receiving portion **65**.

(81) Also, the engagement portions **80** in this example are provided in an intermediate portion of the receiving portion **65** in the circumferential direction, instead of being provided at two end portions of the receiving portion **65** in the circumferential direction thereof. The engagement portions **66** or **80** may be provided in an intermediate portion of the receiving portion **65** in the circumferential direction thereof in this manner.

(82) Also, the engagement portions **66** or **80** may be provided on the entire circumferential portion of the receiving portion **65**.

(83) Further, any number of engagement portions **66** or **80**, such as three or more engagement portions **66** or **80**, may be provided on the receiving portion **65** in the circumferential direction thereof. Although the receiving portion **65** has the engagement portions **66** or **80** in the above-described embodiment, the present disclosure is not limited to this. A configuration may be adopted

in which the receiving portion **65** does not have an engagement portion **66** or **80**. Although the second route-regulating member **60** has two cable ties **62** in the above-described embodiment, the present disclosure is not limited to this, and a configuration may be adopted in which the second route-regulating member **60** has one, three, or more cable ties **62**. Naturally, the number of engagement portions **66** or **80** may be changed according to the number of cable ties **62**. Although the cable tie **62** having the belt-shaped portion **68** and the locking portion **69** is used as a band in the above-described embodiment, the band may be changed to another pliable band that covers the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** together with the receiving portion **65** and can bind the receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** together.

(84) The band may extend from one end portion of the receiving portion **65** in the circumferential direction, be fixed to the other end portion, and bind the receiving portion **65** and the first route-regulating member **40** together.

(85) Specifically, modifications can be made as shown in FIG. **8**, for example. A band **81** in this example is integrated with a receiving portion **82**. That is, the band **81** is a component integrally molded with the receiving portion **82**. Note that the receiving portion **82** in this example does not have an engagement portion **66**. The band **81** extends from one end portion of the receiving portion **82** in the circumferential direction thereof. The band **81** is thinner and more pliable than the receiving portion **82**. A band locking portion **83** is provided at the other end portion of the receiving portion **82** in the circumferential direction thereof. The band locking portion **83** regulates movement of the band **81** in a removing direction that is a direction opposite to the direction in which the band **81** is passed therethrough, and locks the band **81**, in a state in which the band **81** is passed therethrough. Also, the band **81** is passed through the band locking portion **83** while the band **81** covers the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** together with the receiving portion **82**, and binds the receiving portion **82** and the first route-regulating member **40** together.

(86) As a result, the band **81** with a short length can bind the receiving portion **82** and the first route-regulating member **40** together. That is, it is possible to shorten the required length of the band, compared to the cable tie **62** that is attached so as to cover the entire circumferential portion of the receiving portion **65** and cover the entire circumference of the first route-regulating member **40** together with the receiving portion **65** as in the above-described embodiment, or the like. Also, because the band **81** is a component molded integrally with the receiving portion **82**, the number of components can be reduced compared to another configuration, for example. The second route-regulating member **60** of the above-described embodiment is formed so as to regulate the route of the bent section **11B** of the wire harness main body **11**, but there is no limitation to this. For example, the second route-regulating member **60** may be changed to a shape that regulates the route of the straight section **11A** of the wire harness main body **11**. The second route-regulating member **60** in this case is changed to, for example, a shape in which the bent shape of the main body portion **64** extends linearly. Although the second route-regulating member **60** is embodied as an attachment member attached to the first route-regulating member **40** in the above-described embodiment, the present disclosure is not limited to this. The attachment member may be embodied as a vehicle attachment member for attaching the first route-regulating member **40** to the vehicle **V**, for example. The structure of the first route-regulating member **40** of the above-described embodiment can be changed as appropriate. For example, as long as the first route-regulating member **40** has the insertion port **40X** and has a structure with which the first route-regulating member **40** can be attached to the outer circumference of the outer cover member **30**, there is no particular limitation to the other structures. The protruding portion **45** of the above-described embodiment may be provided at a position farther from the insertion port **40X** than the leading end of the first end portion **41** in the circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The protruding portion **46** of the above-described embodiment may be provided at a position farther from the insertion port **40X** than the leading end of the second end portion **42** in the

circumferential direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. The protruding portions **45** and **46** of the above-described embodiment may also be partially provided in the lengthwise direction of the first route-regulating member **40**. At least one of the protruding portions **45** and **46** of the above-described embodiment may be omitted. In the first route-regulating member **40** of the above-described embodiment, the thickness in the radial direction of the connection portion **43** may be changed in the circumferential direction. The shape of the connection portion **43** in the first route-regulating member **40** of the above-described embodiment is not limited to an arc shape, and can be changed to, for example, an elliptical arc shape, a U shape, or the like. In the above-described embodiment, the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** are more rigid than the outer cover member **30**, but there is no limitation to this, and the hardness may be less than or equal to that of the outer cover member **30**. That is, the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** need only act so that the wire harness main body **11** is less likely to bend than the wire harness main body **11** in the state where the first route-regulating member **40** and the second route-regulating member **60** are not attached. For example, the outer cover member **30** in the above-described embodiment may be a resin corrugated tube with a metal layer that contains a metal material, formed on the outer surface thereof. The outer cover member **30** in the above-described embodiment is not limited to being a corrugated tube, and may be an outer cover member that is not provided with a large-diameter portion **31** or a small-diameter portion **32**, for example. The outer cover member **30** in the above-described embodiment may have a slit that extends in the lengthwise direction of the outer cover member **30**. Although the electric wires **21** in the above-described embodiment are high-voltage electric wires, the present disclosure is not limited to such a configuration. For example, the electric wires **21** may be low-voltage electric wires. In the electric wire member **20** in the above-described embodiment, an electromagnetic shield member is embodied as the braided member **25**. However, the present disclosure is not limited to such a configuration. For example, the electromagnetic shield member in the electric wire member **20** may be embodied as a metal foil. The braided member **25** of the electric wire member **20** in the above-described embodiment may be omitted. In the above-described embodiment, the number of electric wires **21** included in the electric wire member **20** is two. However, the present disclosure is not limited to such a configuration. The number of electric wires **21** may be one or three or more. The positional relationship between the inverter M1 and the high-voltage battery M2 in the vehicle V is not limited to that in the above-described embodiment, and may be changed as appropriate depending on the vehicle configuration. In the above-described embodiment, a plurality of on-board devices to which the wire harness **10** is to be electrically connected are embodied as the inverter M1 and the high-voltage battery M2. However, the present disclosure is not limited to such a configuration. The plurality of on-board devices to which the wire harness **10** is to be electrically connected are not particularly limited as long as they are electric devices to be mounted in the vehicle V. The embodiments disclosed herein are illustrative in all aspects and should not be considered restrictive. The scope of the present disclosure is indicated by the scope of claims, not the above-mentioned meaning, and is intended to include all modifications within the meaning and scope equivalent to the scope of claims.

Claims

1. A wire harness comprising: a wire harness main body including an electric wire and an outer cover covering an outer circumference of the electric wire; a first route regulator that is attached to an outer circumference of the outer cover and regulates a route of the wire harness main body; and an attachment that is attached to a portion of an outer circumference of the first route regulator in a lengthwise direction of the first route regulator, wherein: the first route regulator includes an insertion port that is open in a direction orthogonal to the lengthwise direction of the first route regulator and extends along an entire first route regulator in the lengthwise direction of the first

route regulator, the attachment includes a receiver covering a portion in a circumferential direction of the first route regulator, and a pliable band that covers an entire circumference of the first route regulator together with the receiver and binds the receiver and the first route regulator together, the receiver includes an engagement including a through-hole through which the band passes, and a thickness of the first route regulator in a radial direction varies in the circumferential direction, wherein the outer cover has an accordion structure in which large-diameter portions and small-diameter portions are alternately provided along a lengthwise direction of the outer cover, and the attachment is a second route regulator having a body portion that is attached to the large-diameter portion of the outer cover and regulates the route of the wire harness main body.

2. The wire harness according to claim 1, wherein: the band is a cable tie that includes a pliable belt and a lock that is provided at an end of the belt in a lengthwise direction of the belt and regulates movement of the belt in a removing direction, which is a direction opposite to a direction in which the belt is passed therethrough, in a state in which the belt is passed therethrough, and the cable tie is attached so as to cover an entire circumferential portion of the receiver and cover the entire circumference of the first route regulator together with the receiver.

3. The wire harness according to claim 2, wherein the engagement is configured to engage with the belt in a lengthwise direction of the receiver.

4. The wire harness according to claim 3, wherein the engagement is a plurality of engagements, each of the engagements being provided at one of two ends of the receiver in a circumferential direction of the receiver, and each of the engagements respectively includes a through-hole.

5. The wire harness according to claim 1, wherein the band extends from one end of the receiver in the circumferential direction of the receiver, is fixed to the other end, and binds the receiver and the first route regulator together.

6. The wire harness according to claim 5, wherein the band is a component molded integrally with the receiver.

7. The wire harness according to claim 1, wherein: the receiver is formed at an end of the body portion in a lengthwise direction of the second route regulator and covers a circumferential portion of an end of the first route regulator in the lengthwise direction of the first route regulator.

8. The wire harness according to claim 7, wherein: a straight shape portion of the first route regulator regulates a first section of the route of the wire harness main body, which is a section having a linear shape in the route of the wire harness main body, and a bent section of the body portion of the second route regulator regulates a second section of the route of the wire harness main body, which is a section that is bent in the route of the wire harness main body.
